

Introduction to Category Theory

Eduardo Magalhães

Definition

A *category* $\mathcal{C}$ consists of the following data:

- A collection $\text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$ of *objects*;
- For each pair of objects A, B , a collection $\text{hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(A, B)$ whose elements are called *morphisms* or *arrows*;
- Composition: Given two morphisms $f: A \rightarrow B$ e $g: B \rightarrow C$, there exists a morphism $g \circ f: A \rightarrow C$;

Such that:

- Composition is associative;
- For each object A , there exists a morphism $1_A: A \rightarrow A$ called the *identity morphism* that acts as an identity for composition;

Notation:

We write $A \in \mathcal{C}$ for $A \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$
 $\text{hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(A, B)$, $\text{hom}(A, B) \in \mathcal{C}(A, B)$

Examples

- **Set, Grp, Mon, Ring, Vect $\mathbb{R}$, Top**
- **N**
- Preorder / Partial order $(X, \leq)$
- **Mat($\mathbb{R}$)**
- Monoid M / group G

Types of Morphisms

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. A morphism $f : A \rightarrow B$ is said to be an *isomorphism* or *invertible*, if there exists a morphism $g : B \rightarrow A$ such that $gf = 1_A$ e $fg = 1_B$.

If that is the case, we say that the objects A and B are *isomorphic*, which we denote by $A \cong B$.

Note: if f is an isomorphism, then its inverse is unique, so we use the notation f^{-1} .

Definition

A group G is a category with only one object where every morphism is an isomorphism.

Note: A category where every morphism is an isomorphism is called a *groupoid*.

Monomorphisms

Proposition

Let X, Y be sets and $f : X \rightarrow Y$ a function. The following are equivalent:

- f is injective;
- Given functions g, h :

$$Z \begin{array}{c} \xrightarrow{g} \\ \xrightarrow{h} \end{array} X \xrightarrow{f} Y$$

If $fg = fh$, then $g = h$;

- There exists a function $w : Y \rightarrow X$ such that $wf = 1_X$.

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. A morphism $f : A \rightarrow B$ is a **monomorphism** or **mono** if, for any morphisms $g, h : C \rightrightarrows A$, the equality $fg = fh$ implies that $g = h$.

Epimorphisms

Proposition

Let X, Y be sets and $f : X \rightarrow Y$ a function. The following are equivalent:

- f is surjective;
- Given two functions g, h :

$$X \xrightarrow{f} Y \begin{matrix} \xrightarrow{g} \\ \xrightarrow{h} \end{matrix} Z$$

If $gf = hf$, then $g = h$;

- There exists a function $w : Y \rightarrow X$ such that $fw = 1_Y$.

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. A morphism $f : A \rightarrow B$ is an *epimorphism* or *epic* if, for any morphisms $g, h : B \rightrightarrows C$, $gf = hf$ implies $g = h$.

Proposition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. If f is an isomorphism, then f is both a monomorphism and an epimorphism.

Note: f being a monomorphism + epimorphism does not imply that f is an isomorphism.

A category where this happens is called *balanced*.

Terminal and initial objects

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. An object A is called:

- *terminal* if for every object B there exists exactly one morphism $B \rightarrow A$;
- *initial* if for every object B there exists exactly one morphism $A \rightarrow B$.

Proposition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. Then:

- *If $\mathcal{C}$ has a terminal object, then it is unique up to isomorphism;*
- *If $\mathcal{C}$ has an initial object, then it is unique up to isomorphism;*

Note: the terminal object is usually denoted by 1 and the initial object by 0 or $\emptyset$.

Opposite Category

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. The *opposite category* of $\mathcal{C}$, denoted by $\mathcal{C}^{\text{op}}$, is given by:

- The objects of $\mathcal{C}^{\text{op}}$ are the objects of $\mathcal{C}$;
- The morphisms $\mathcal{C}^{\text{op}}$ are the same as the morphisms in $\mathcal{C}$, but we 'flip' the direction. Formally:

$$\text{hom}_{\mathcal{C}^{\text{op}}}(A, B) := \text{hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(B, A)$$

- Composition is given by $g \circ_{\text{op}} f = f \circ g$;

Proposition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. Then:

- An object A is terminal [initial] in $\mathcal{C}$ iff A is initial [terminal] in $\mathcal{C}^{\text{op}}$;
- A morphism f is mono [epic] in $\mathcal{C}$ iff f is epic [mono] in $\mathcal{C}^{\text{op}}$.

Product of Categories

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}$ be categories. We define $\mathcal{C} \times \mathcal{D}$ as being the category given by:

- The objects are pairs (A, B) , where $A \in \mathcal{C}$ e $B \in \mathcal{D}$. In other words $\text{Ob}(\mathcal{C} \times \mathcal{D}) = \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C}) \times \text{Ob}(\mathcal{D})$;
- A morphism $(A, B) \rightarrow (A', B')$ is given by a pair (f, g) where $f : A \rightarrow A'$ is a morphism in $\mathcal{C}$ and $g : B \rightarrow B'$ is a morphism in $\mathcal{D}$;

Composition of two morphisms:

$$(A, B) \xrightarrow{(f, g)} (A', B') \xrightarrow{(f', g')} (A'', B'')$$

is defined as $(f', g') \circ (f, g) = (f' \circ f, g' \circ g)$.

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}$ be categories. A *functor* $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ is given by:

- For each object $A \in \mathcal{C}$, an object $F(A)$ in $\mathcal{D}$;
- Given a morphism $f : A \rightarrow B$ in $\mathcal{C}$, a morphism $F(f)$ in $\mathcal{D}$:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & & F(A) \\ f \downarrow & \xrightarrow{F} & \downarrow F(f) \\ B & & F(B) \end{array}$$

Such that $F(1_A) = 1_{F(A)}$ for every object $A \in \mathcal{C}$, and

$F(f \circ g) = F(f) \circ F(g)$ for all composable morphisms $A \xrightarrow{g} B \xrightarrow{f} C$ in $\mathcal{C}$.

Functors II

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C} \xrightarrow{F} \mathcal{D} \xrightarrow{G} \mathcal{K}$ be functors. We define the composition $G \circ F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{K}$ to be the functor given by:

- For any $A \in \mathcal{C}$, then $(G \circ F)(A) = G(F(A))$;
- For any morphism f in $\mathcal{C}$, then $(G \circ F)(f) = G(F(f))$.

Definition

We define **Cat** as being the category whose objects are categories, and morphisms are functors, where composition is defined as above.

Definition

Two categories $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}$ are said to be isomorphic if they are isomorphic as objects in **Cat**. In other words, if there are functors $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ and $G : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ such that $GF = 1_{\mathcal{C}}$ e $FG = 1_{\mathcal{D}}$.

Full and Faithful

Note: Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ be a functor. For each pair of objects $A, B \in \mathcal{C}$, the functor F induces a map

$$\begin{aligned} F : \operatorname{hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(A, B) &\rightarrow \operatorname{hom}_{\mathcal{D}}(F(A), F(B)) \\ f &\mapsto F(f) \end{aligned} \tag{1}$$

Definition

A functor $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ is said to be:

- *Full*, if the map (1) is surjective;
- *Faithful*, if the map (1) is injective.

Proposition

Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ be a functor. Then F is an isomorphism iff it is bijective on objects, and fully faithful.

Proposition

Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ be a functor. Then:

- 1. F preserves isomorphisms;*
- 2. If F is fully faithful, then F reflects isomorphisms;*
- 3. If F is faithful, then F reflects monomorphisms and epimorphisms.*

Corollary

Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ be a functor and A, B objects in $\mathcal{C}$. If $A \cong B$, then $F(A) \cong F(B)$, where the converse is true if, for example, F is fully faithful.

Contravariant Functors

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}$ be categories. A *contravariant functor* $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ is given by:

- For each object $A \in \mathcal{C}$, an object $F(A)$ in $\mathcal{D}$;
- Given a morphism $f : A \rightarrow B$ in $\mathcal{C}$, a morphism $F(f)$ in $\mathcal{D}$:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & & F(A) \\ f \downarrow & \xrightarrow{F} & \uparrow F(f) \\ B & & F(B) \end{array}$$

Such that $F(1_A) = 1_{F(A)}$ for every object $A \in \mathcal{C}$, and

$F(f \circ g) = F(g) \circ F(f)$ for all composable morphisms $A \xrightarrow{g} B \xrightarrow{f} C$ in $\mathcal{C}$.

Contravariant Functors II

Proposition

A *contravariant functor* from $\mathcal{C}$ to $\mathcal{D}$ is the same thing as a functor $F : \mathcal{C}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$.

Proposition

Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ be a functor. Then F is also a functor from $\mathcal{C}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}^{\text{op}}$.

Note: As such, a functor $F : \mathcal{C}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ is the same thing as a functor $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}^{\text{op}}$.

Proposition

The assignment $\mathcal{C} \mapsto \mathcal{C}^{\text{op}}$ and $F \mapsto F$ defines a functor **Cat** $\rightarrow$ **Cat**.

Natural Transformations

Definition

Let $F, G : \mathcal{C} \Rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ be two functors. A *natural transformation* $\alpha : F \Rightarrow G$ is given by, for each $C \in \mathcal{D}$, a morphism

$$\alpha_C : F(C) \rightarrow G(C)$$

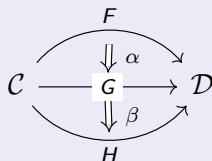
in $\mathcal{D}$, called the *components* of α in C , such that for each morphism $f : A \rightarrow B$ in $\mathcal{C}$, the following diagram called the *naturality square* of α commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} F(A) & \xrightarrow{\alpha_A} & G(A) \\ F(f) \downarrow & & \downarrow G(f) \\ F(B) & \xrightarrow{\alpha_B} & G(B) \end{array}$$

Composition of Natural Transformations

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}$ be two categories, and consider the following functors and natural transformations:



We define the composite $\beta \circ \alpha : F \Rightarrow H$ as the natural transformation with components given by the composition of α_A followed by β_A :

$$(\beta \circ \alpha)_A : F(A) \xrightarrow{\alpha_A} G(A) \xrightarrow{\beta_A} H(A)$$

so $(\beta \circ \alpha)_A = \beta_A \circ \alpha_A$ for each $A \in \mathcal{C}$.

Functor Categories

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}$ be two categories. We define $[\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{D}]$ as being the category whose objects are functors from $\mathcal{C}$ to $\mathcal{D}$ and morphisms are natural transformations.

Definition

Two functors $F, G : \mathcal{C} \Rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ are said to be *naturally isomorphic*, written as $F \cong G$, if they are isomorphic as objects in $[\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{D}]$, i.e. if there are natural transformations $\alpha : F \Rightarrow G$ and $\beta : G \Rightarrow F$ such that $\alpha \circ \beta = 1_G$ and $\beta \circ \alpha = 1_F$. If this is the case, we say that α and β are *natural isomorphisms*.

Proposition

Let $F, G : \mathcal{C} \Rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ be two functors and $\alpha : F \Rightarrow G$ a natural transformation. Then α is a natural isomorphism iff for each $A \in \mathcal{C}$, the component $\alpha_A : F(A) \rightarrow G(A)$ is an isomorphism in $\mathcal{D}$.

Equivalent Categories

Note: Given two functors $F, G : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$, we say that

$$F(A) \cong G(A), \text{ naturally in } A$$

to mean that F and G are naturally isomorphic.

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}$ be categories. We say that $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}$ are *equivalent*, denoted by $\mathcal{C} \simeq \mathcal{D}$, if there are functors $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ and $G : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ such that $F \circ G \cong 1_{\mathcal{D}}$ and $G \circ F \cong 1_{\mathcal{C}}$. If this is the case, then we say that F is an *equivalence* of categories.

A functor $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ is said to be *essentially surjective on objects*, if for each $B \in \mathcal{D}$, there is some $A \in \mathcal{C}$ such that $F(A) \cong B$.

Proposition

Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ be a functor. Then F is an equivalence iff F is fully faithful and essentially surjective on objects.

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. A *subcategory* $\mathcal{D}$ is given by:

- A subset $\text{Ob}(\mathcal{D}) \subseteq \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$ of objects;
- For each pair $A, B \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{D})$, a subset of morphisms $\text{hom}_{\mathcal{D}}(A, B) \subseteq \text{hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(A, B)$

Such that $\mathcal{D}$ is itself a category.

Definition

A subcategory $\mathcal{D} \subseteq \mathcal{C}$ is said to be a *full subcategory* if $\text{hom}_{\mathcal{D}}(A, B) = \text{hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(A, B)$ for all $A, B \in \mathcal{D}$, i.e. if the inclusion functor $\iota : \mathcal{D} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{C}$ is full. (note that the inclusion functor is always faithful).

Definition

A category $\mathcal{C}$ is said to be *skeletal*, if for any two objects $A, B \in \mathcal{C}$, if $A \cong B$ then $A = B$.

A *skeleton* of a category $\mathcal{C}$ is a skeletal subcategory whose inclusion functor is an equivalence.

Theorem

Every category has a skeleton. Furthermore, such skeleton is unique up to isomorphism.

Furthermore, two categories are equivalent if and only if they have isomorphic skeletons.

Dualities

An equivalence $\mathcal{C}^{\text{op}} \simeq \mathcal{D}$ is called a *duality* between the categories $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}$.

Examples:

- Stone duality:

$$\{\text{Boolean Algebras}\}^{\text{op}} \simeq \{\text{totally disconnected compact } T_2 \text{ spaces}\}$$

- Gelfand-Naimark duality:

$$\{\text{Commutative unital } C^*\text{-algebras}\}^{\text{op}} \simeq \{\text{compact } T_2 \text{ spaces}\}$$

- In algebraic geometry, given a ACF k :

$$\{\text{Affine Varieties over } k\}^{\text{op}} \simeq \{\text{f.g. } k\text{-algebras with no nontrivial nilpotents}\}$$

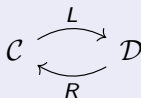
- Pontryagin Duality:

$$\{\text{Locally compact abelian top. Groups}\}^{\text{op}} \simeq \{\text{Locally compact abelian top. Groups}\}$$

Adjunctions

Definition

Consider categories and functors as follows:



We say that L is *left adjoint* to R and that R is *right adjoint* to L , written as $L \dashv R$, if there exists an isomorphism

$$\mathrm{hom}_{\mathcal{D}}(L(A), B) \cong \mathrm{hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(A, R(B)) \quad (2)$$

natural in $A \in \mathcal{C}$ and $B \in \mathcal{D}$.

An *adjunction* between L and R is a choice of isomorphism as in (2).

Adjunctions II

The bijection $\text{hom}_{\mathcal{D}}(L(A), B) \cong \text{hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(A, R(B))$ creates the assignment:

$$\begin{aligned} \left(L(A) \xrightarrow{g} B \right) &\mapsto \left(A \xrightarrow{\bar{g}} R(B) \right) \\ \left(L(A) \xrightarrow{\bar{f}} B \right) &\leftarrow \left(A \xrightarrow{f} R(B) \right) \end{aligned}$$

Where $\bar{\bar{f}} = f$. We call $\bar{f}$ the *transpose* of f . Naturality is the same thing as the following two conditions

$$\overline{\left(L(A) \xrightarrow{g} B \xrightarrow{q} B' \right)} = \left(A \xrightarrow{\bar{g}} R(B) \xrightarrow{R(q)} R(B') \right) \quad (3)$$

$$\overline{\left(A' \xrightarrow{p} A \xrightarrow{f} R(B) \right)} = \left(L(A') \xrightarrow{L(p)} L(A) \xrightarrow{\bar{f}} B \right) \quad (4)$$

That is, $\overline{q \circ g} = R(q) \circ \bar{g}$ and $\overline{f \circ p} = \bar{f} \circ L(p)$

Adjunctions III

Proposition

Consider adjunctions

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \mathcal{C} & \xrightleftharpoons[L]{L} & \mathcal{D} & \xrightleftharpoons[R']{L'} & \mathcal{E} \end{array}$$

Then, $L' \circ L \dashv R \circ R'$. In fact, we have

$$\mathrm{hom}_{\mathcal{E}}(L'L(A), B) \cong \mathrm{hom}_{\mathcal{D}}(L(A), R'(B)) \cong \mathrm{hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(A, RR'(B))$$

Proposition

Left adjoints preserve initial objects and right adjoints preserve terminal objects.

Unit and Counit

Consider an adjunction

$$\mathcal{C} \begin{array}{c} \xrightarrow{L} \\ \perp \\ \xleftarrow{R} \end{array} \mathcal{D}$$

From the bijection $\text{hom}_{\mathcal{D}}(L(A), B) \cong \text{hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(A, R(B))$, we obtain the following bijection natural in $A \in \mathcal{C}$:

$$\text{hom}_{\mathcal{D}}(L(A), L(A)) \cong \text{hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(A, RL(A)) \quad (5)$$

In particular, for each $A \in \mathcal{C}$, we have a morphism

$$\left(A \xrightarrow{\eta_A} RL(A) \right) = \overline{\left(L(A) \xrightarrow{1} L(A) \right)}$$

Proposition

*Consider an adjunction as above. Then, the maps $\eta_A : A \rightarrow RL(A)$ form a natural transformation $\eta : 1_{\mathcal{C}} \Rightarrow RL$, known as the **unit** of the adjunction $L \dashv R$.*

Unit and Counit II

Consider an adjunction

$$\mathcal{C} \begin{array}{c} \xrightarrow{L} \\ \perp \\ \xleftarrow{R} \end{array} \mathcal{D}$$

From the bijection $\text{hom}_{\mathcal{D}}(L(A), B) \cong \text{hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(A, R(B))$, we obtain the following bijection natural in $B \in \mathcal{D}$:

$$\text{hom}_{\mathcal{D}}(LR(B), B) \cong \text{hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(R(B), R(B)) \quad (6)$$

In particular, for each $B \in \mathcal{D}$, we have a morphism

$$\left(LR(B) \xrightarrow{\varepsilon_B} B \right) = \overline{\left(R(B) \xrightarrow{1} R(B) \right)}$$

Proposition

Consider an adjunction as above. Then, the maps $\varepsilon_B : LR(B) \rightarrow B$ form a natural transformation $\varepsilon : LR \Rightarrow 1_{\mathcal{D}}$, known as the **counit** of the adjunction $L \dashv R$.

Whiskering of natural transformations

Consider the following:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{C} & \begin{array}{c} \xrightarrow{F} \\ \Downarrow \alpha \\ \xrightarrow{H} \end{array} & \mathcal{D} \xrightarrow{G} \mathcal{E} \end{array}$$

Then we have a composite:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{C} & \begin{array}{c} \xrightarrow{GF} \\ \Downarrow G\alpha \\ \xrightarrow{GH} \end{array} & \mathcal{E} \end{array}$$

With components

$$(G\alpha)_A := G(\alpha_A) : G(F(A)) \rightarrow G(H(A))$$

Whiskering of natural transformations II

Consider the following:

$$\mathcal{E} \xrightarrow{G} \mathcal{C} \begin{array}{c} \xrightarrow{F} \mathcal{D} \\ \Downarrow \alpha \\ \xrightarrow{H} \mathcal{D} \end{array}$$

Then we have a composite:

$$\mathcal{E} \begin{array}{c} \xrightarrow{FG} \mathcal{D} \\ \Downarrow \alpha G \\ \xrightarrow{HG} \mathcal{D} \end{array}$$

With components

$$(\alpha G)_A := \alpha_{G(A)} : F(G(A)) \rightarrow H(G(A))$$

Proposition

Consider an adjunction

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & L & \\ \mathcal{C} & \begin{array}{c} \xrightarrow{\quad} \\ \perp \\ \xleftarrow{\quad} \end{array} & \mathcal{D} \\ & R & \end{array}$$

with unit η and counit ε . Then the following triangles commute (in $[\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{D}]$ and $[\mathcal{D}, \mathcal{C}]$ resp.)

$$\begin{array}{ccc} L & \xrightarrow{L\eta} & LRL \\ & \searrow 1_L & \downarrow \varepsilon L \\ & & L \end{array} \qquad \begin{array}{ccc} R & \xrightarrow{\eta R} & RLR \\ & \searrow 1_R & \downarrow R\varepsilon \\ & & R \end{array}$$

These two triangles are known as the *triangle identities*.

Proposition

Consider an adjunction

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{C} & \begin{array}{c} \xrightarrow{L} \\ \perp \\ \xleftarrow{R} \end{array} & \mathcal{D} \end{array}$$

with unit η and counit ε , and let $A \in \mathcal{C}$ and $B \in \mathcal{D}$. Then, for any $g : L(A) \rightarrow B$,

$$\bar{g} = R(g) \circ \eta_A$$

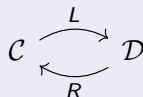
and for any $g : A \rightarrow R(B)$, we have that

$$\bar{f} = \varepsilon_B \circ L(f)$$

Adjunctions = Unit and Counit

Theorem

Consider two categories and functors



Then, there is a one-to-one correspondence between:

- 1. Adjunctions between L and R (with L being left adjoint);*
- 2. Pairs $(\eta : 1_{\mathcal{C}} \Rightarrow RL, \varepsilon : LR \Rightarrow 1_{\mathcal{D}})$ of natural transformations satisfying the triangle identities.*

Corollary

Using the same notation as the last theorem, there exists an adjunction $L \dashv R$ if and only if there are natural transformations $\eta : 1_{\mathcal{C}} \Rightarrow RL$ and $\varepsilon : LR \Rightarrow 1_{\mathcal{D}}$ satisfying the triangle identities.

So we can think of adjunctions as:

1. Triples (L, R, Φ) with

$$\mathrm{hom}_{\mathcal{D}}(L(-), -) \stackrel{\Phi}{\cong} \mathrm{hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(-, R(-))$$

2. Quadruples $(L, R, \eta, \varepsilon)$ where $\eta : 1_{\mathcal{C}} \Rightarrow RL$ and $\varepsilon : LR \Rightarrow 1_{\mathcal{D}}$ satisfying the triangle identities.

Definition

A category $\mathcal{C}$ is said to be:

- *Small*, if the collection of all arrows is a set;
- *Locally small* if for every $A, B \in \mathcal{C}$, the collection $\text{hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(A, B)$ is a set;
- *Essentially small* if it is equivalent to a small category;

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a locally small category, and fix an object A . We define a functor

$$h^A : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$$

as follows:

- For $B \in \mathcal{C}$, we define $h^A(B) = \text{hom}(A, B)$;
- For $f : B \rightarrow C$, then $h^A(f)$ is given by

$$\begin{aligned} h^A(f) : h^A(B) &\rightarrow h^A(C) \\ h &\mapsto f \circ h \end{aligned}$$

The notation $\text{hom}(A, -)$ is also common for h^A . We also sometimes denote $h^A(f)$ by $f \circ -$ or f_* .

Representables II

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a locally small category and $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$ a functor. We say that F is *representable* if there exists some object $A \in \mathcal{C}$ such that $F \cong h^A$. A *representation* of F is a choice of object A and isomorphism between h^A and F .

Representables functors are sometimes just called *representables*.

Theorem

Any functor $R : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$ with a left adjoint is representable.

Representables III

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a locally small category and consider a morphism $f : A \rightarrow B$. Then this induces a natural transformation:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{C} & \begin{array}{c} \xrightarrow{h^B} \\ \Downarrow h^f \\ \xrightarrow{h^A} \end{array} & \mathbf{Set} \end{array}$$

Where, for each $C \in \mathcal{C}$, the component of h^f is

$$\begin{aligned} (h^f)_C : h^B(C) &\rightarrow h^A(C) \\ p &\mapsto p \circ f \end{aligned}$$

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a locally small category. We define a functor

$$h^\bullet : \mathcal{C}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow [\mathcal{C}, \mathbf{Set}]$$

Where, given an object A , its image is h^A and, given an arrow f , its image is h^f .

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a locally small category, and fix an object A . We define a functor

$$h_A : \mathcal{C}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$$

as follows:

- For $B \in \mathcal{C}$, we define $h_A(B) = \text{hom}(B, A)$;
- For $f : B \rightarrow C$, then $h_A(f)$ is given by

$$\begin{aligned} h_A(f) : h_A(C) &\rightarrow h_A(B) \\ h &\mapsto h \circ f \end{aligned}$$

The notation $\text{hom}(-, A)$ is also common for h_A . We also sometimes denote $h_A(f)$ by $- \circ f$ or f^* .

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a locally small category and $F : \mathcal{C}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$ a functor. We say that F is *representable* if there exists some object $A \in \mathcal{C}$ such that $F \cong h_A$. A *representation* of F is a choice of object A and isomorphism between h_A and F .

Recall: Functors of the form $F : \mathcal{C}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$ are usually called *presheaves* on $\mathcal{C}$.

Representables VII

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a locally small category and consider a morphism $f : A \rightarrow B$.
Then this induces a natural transformation:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{C}^{\text{op}} & \begin{array}{c} \xrightarrow{h_A} \\ \Downarrow h_f \\ \xrightarrow{h_B} \end{array} & \mathbf{Set} \end{array}$$

Where, for each $C \in \mathcal{C}$, the component of h_f is

$$\begin{aligned} (h_f)_C : h_A(C) &\rightarrow h_B(C) \\ p &\mapsto f \circ p \end{aligned}$$

Definition

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a locally small category. The *Yoneda embedding* is the functor

$$h_{\bullet} : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow [\mathcal{C}^{\text{op}}, \mathbf{Set}]$$

Where, given an object A , its image is h_A and, given an arrow f , its image is h_f .

Yoneda Lemma

Theorem (Yoneda)

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a locally small category. Then

$$\mathrm{hom}_{[\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{op}}, \mathbf{Set}]}(h_A, F) \cong F(A)$$

naturally in $A \in \mathcal{C}$ and $F \in [\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{op}}, \mathbf{Set}]$.

Corollary

For any locally small category $\mathcal{C}$, the Yoneda embedding

$$h_{\bullet} : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow [\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{op}}, \mathbf{Set}]$$

is fully faithful.

Yoneda Lemma II

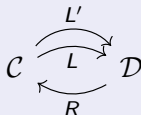
Corollary

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a locally small category, and $A, B \in \mathcal{C}$. Then:

$$h_A \cong h_B \iff A \cong B \iff h^A \cong h^B$$

Corollary

Consider functors



If $L \dashv R$ and $L' \dashv R$, then $L \cong L'$, i.e. the left adjoint of a fixed functor R are unique, up to isomorphism. The same goes for right adjoints.